

SEVENTH-DAY ADVENTIST CANON

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Dexter Hadley, MD/PhD

Hadley Lab CANONIC

Abstract

Example

Contents

The seventh-day Sabbath (Saturday) is Gods seal of authority in creation, the mark of loyalty in the end-time conflict.

Example: Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy (Exodus 20:8-11). SDA distinguishes itself from ALL other Protestant denominations on this point. The Sabbath is not merely a day of rest it is the D that separates SDA from Sunday-keeping Christendom. In SDA eschatology, the Sabbath becomes the ultimate test of allegiance.

2. Sanctuary Doctrine (Investigative Judgment)

On October 22, 1844, Christ entered the Most Holy Place of the heavenly sanctuary to begin a work of investigative judgment.

Example: After the Great Disappointment (Millers failed prediction of Christs return on October 22, 1844), Hiram Edsons vision reinterpreted the event: not earth but heaven. Daniel 8:14 Unto two thousand and three hundred days; then shall the sanctuary be cleansed. The sanctuary doctrine transforms a prophetic failure into a distinctive theological claim.

3. Great Controversy Worldview

Cosmic conflict between Christ and Satan frames ALL of history from Lucifers rebellion to the Second Coming to the millennium to the New Earth.

Example: Ellen Whites *The Great Controversy* (1858-1911) provides the T a temporal narrative spanning from Jerusalems destruction (70 CE) through the Dark Ages, Reformation, and Millerite movement to end-time events. This is SDAs master narrative: everything that happens is a move in the cosmic chess match.

4. Spirit of Prophecy (Ellen G. White)

Ellen White (1827-1915) had the prophetic gift. Her writings are authoritative for church practice and belief, though subordinate to Scripture.

Example: SDA does NOT claim Ellen White wrote new scripture (that would be Latter-day Saints territory). The claim is more subtle: she had the Spirit of Prophecy (Revelation 19:10), a lesser light pointing to the greater light (the Bible). Her 100,000+ pages of writing cover health, education, theology, church organization, and prophecy.

5. Health Message

The body is the temple of the Holy Spirit. SDA advocates vegetarianism, abstinence from alcohol/tobacco/caffeine, and wholistic health.

Example: Leviticus 11 clean/unclean meats + 1 Corinthians 6:19 (body as temple) + Ellen Whites health reform visions (1863). This is OPERATIONAL governance of the physical body. SDA operates one of the largest healthcare systems in the world (Adventist Health, Loma Linda University Medical Center). The Blue Zone in Loma Linda, CA SDA community has some of the longest-lived people on earth.

6. Second Coming (Adventist Hope)

The literal, visible, imminent return of Jesus Christ is the blessed hope the event that gives the denomination its name.

Example: Adventist = one who awaits the Advent (coming). Unlike postmillennialists or amillennialists, SDA holds premillennial eschatology: Christ returns BEFORE the millennium. Signs of the times (Matthew 24) indicate imminence. The name IS the declaration.

7. Conditional Immortality (Soul Sleep)

Humans do not have inherent immortality. The dead are unconscious until the resurrection. No eternal hellfire the wicked are annihilated.

Example: The living know that they will die, but the dead know nothing (Ecclesiastes 9:5). This directly opposes Catholic purgatory, Protestant heaven-at-death, and eternal conscious torment. SDA reads death as sleep (John 11:11-14) and final judgment as destruction, not torture.

8. 28 Fundamental Beliefs

SDA codifies its doctrine in 28 official statements, revised by General Conference session.

Example: The 28 Fundamental Beliefs are SDAs D explicit, numbered, votable. They can be changed (they grew from 22 to 27 to 28). This is unique among Protestant churches: a formal, numbered, democratically revisable creed.

Constraints

MUST: Cite 28 Fundamental Beliefs or Scripture for
 MUST: Distinguish Ellen White counsel from canonica
 MUST NOT: Present SDA distinctive doctrines as mainstr

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